

Across Borders: A Signal

跨越边界：一个信号

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

English Story

The film was delivered and the office was behind them; the next deadline would be in another language. The **fifth** arc began with a journey: a **plane**, a **truck**, a **jeep**, and a **tunnel** in the same week. Aisha met them at the station with a **thermometer** in her bag and a **pronunciation** guide in her hand. “The **tone** of a language is part of its **safety**,” she said. “I is not the same as I am.” They themselves had left a service job for this.

The big case was the rail line itself: a **barrel** of **fluid**, a **coil** of cable, and a **cargo** of berries had been waiting three days. The management of the rail service blamed the **tide**; the minister blamed the weather. “We survive by rumor here,” Aisha said, “and rumor is a **rocky** road.” We have to tell them that, and the night shift at the table was the position where the work of a year stood.

The **hope** was a **quiet** one: that a small team could **steal** a march on a system with a **billion** reasons to ignore them. A **football** match on the platform, a **piano** playing **jazz** in the hall, and a **drum** and a **whip** in the market gave the place a rhythm they did not know. Him they watched most closely of all; itself, the station, kept its own time.

The **prime** difficulty was not technical. “A **mushroom** grows overnight; a habit does not,” their host said. A **pan**, a **chop**, a **knot** of wire, and a **ray** of light through the carriage window: their host used objects to explain **usage**, and the **therapy** of it was patience.

The **hardship** of the journey gave them a **spur**: a **curl** of paper with the timetable, a **spit** of rain on the glass, and the **quiet endurance** of a station cat. “They will treat us as **tame**,” Lin said, “until we are useful.” Aisha, who had created the timetable herself, said nothing. The **king** of the district had died that spring, and the station was **still quiet**; the journey home **via** the coast road was **over** before the **fifth** day. They would remember the **tunnel**, the **tide**, and the **tone** of a farewell for years.

中文翻译

影片交付了，办公室留在了身后；下一个期限会用另一种语言到来。第五段弧线以一段旅程开始：飞机、卡车、吉普车和隧道都出现在同一周。艾莎在车站接他们，包里装着一支温度计，手里拿着一份发音指南。“一种语言的语调是它安全的一部分，”她说，“‘我’和‘我是’不是一回事。”他们自己是放弃了服务工作才来到这里的。

最大的案子就是那条铁路线本身：一桶液体、一卷电缆和一批浆果已经等了三天。铁路管理部门怪潮水；部长怪天气。“我们这里靠传言活着，”艾莎说，“而传言是一条多石的路。”这一点我们必须告诉他们，而桌边的那一班夜岗，正是这一年的工作所站的位置。

那份希望是安静的：一支小团队能在一个有十亿个理由忽视他们的系统里抢占一步。站台上的足球赛、大厅里弹爵士乐的钢琴，以及市场里的鼓和鞭子，给了这个地方一种他们不熟悉的节奏。他们最仔细打量的是他；而车站本身，按着自己的时间走。

最主要的困难不是技术上的。“蘑菇一夜之间就能长出来；习惯不能，”接待他们的人说。一口平锅、一块排骨、一团打结的电线和一缕穿过车厢窗户的光：主人用实物来解释用法，而其中的疗愈之处就是耐心。

旅途的艰难给了他们一个激励：一张写着时刻表的卷纸、玻璃上的一阵雨沫，以及一只站台猫安静的忍耐。“他们会把我们当作温顺的，”林伟说，“直到我们有用。”而亲手做出那张时刻表的艾莎，什么也没说。那年春天，这个地区的国王去世了，车站仍然很安静；沿海岸公路回家的旅程在第五天之前就结束了。他们会记住那条隧道、那道潮水，以及一句告别的语调，记很多年。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
I aɪ POS: pron	pron. 我; [计] 电流, 中断, 指令, 指示符 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the 9th letter of the Roman alphabet
over 'əʊvə POS: adv	adv. 结束, 越过, 从头到尾; prep. 在...之上, 遍于...之上, 越过; a. 上面的; vt. 越过 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (cricket) the division of play during which six balls are bowled at the batsman by one player from the oth...
still stɪl POS: n	n. 蒸馏室, 寂静, 剧照; v. 蒸馏, (使)平静, (使)静止; a. 静止的, 不动的, 静寂的, 不起泡的, 静物摄影的; adv. ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a static photograph (especially one taken from a movie and used for advertising purposes); n. an apparatus...
hope heɪp POS: n	n. 希望, 信心, 期待; v. 希望, 期望, 信赖 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a specific instance of feeling hopeful; n. the general feeling that some desire will be fulfilled; n. someone...
billion 'bɪljən POS: num	num. 十亿, 十亿个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the number that is represented as a one followed by 12 zeros; in the United Kingdom the usage followed in...
king kɪŋ POS: n	n. 国王, 君主; vt. 使...成为君主; vi. 君临, 统治 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a male sovereign; ruler of a kingdom; n. a competitor who holds a preeminent position; n. preeminence in a p...
prime praɪm POS: n	n. 最佳部分, 初期, 全盛期; a. 主要的, 最初的, 根本的; v. 加油启动, 灌注, 灌装 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a number that has no factor but itself and 1; n. the second canonical hour; about 6 a.m.; n. the time of mat...
safety 'seɪftɪ POS: n	n. 安全, 保险, 平安, 保安设备; vt. 保护, 防护 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being certain that adverse effects will not be caused by some agent under defined conditions; ...
plane pleɪn POS: n	n. 平面, 扁平物, 机翼, 飞机, 水准, 地位; a. 平的, 平面的; vt. 将...刨平, 刨平, 掠过水面; vi. 翱翔, 乘飞... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (mathematics) an unbounded two-dimensional shape; n. a level of existence or development; n. a power tool fo...
truck trʌk POS: n	n. 卡车, 货车, 对...进行交易, 来往, 实工资, (供应市场的)蔬菜, 废物, 废话; vt. 对...进行交易, 交往, 以卡... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an automotive vehicle suitable for hauling; v. convey (goods etc.) by truck
survive sə'vaɪv POS: vt	vt. 比...活得长, 生存, 生还, 幸免于; vi. 活下来, 幸存 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. continue to live through hardship or adversity; v. continue in existence after (an adversity, etc.)
football 'fʊtbɔ:l POS: n	n. 足球, 橄榄球 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various games played with a ball (round or oval) in which two teams try to kick or carry or propel...
quiet 'kwaɪət POS: n	n. 安静, 闲适, 平静; a. 安静的, 静止的, 寂静的, 朴素的, 从容的, 暗中的; vi. 平静下来; vt. 使平静, 使平息, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by an absence or near absence of agitation or activity; a. free of noise or uproar; or making...
steal sti:l POS: vi/vt/n	vt. 剽窃; 偷偷地做; 偷窃; vi. 窃取; 偷偷地行动; [棒球]偷垒; n. [口]偷窃; 便宜货; 偷垒; [篮球]断球 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a stolen base; an instance in which a base runner advances safely during the delivery of a pitch (without...
tone təʊn POS: n	n. 音调, 音质, 语调, 语气, 色调, 气氛, 状况, 思想状态; vt. 给...定色调, 增强, 使...的声调和谐, 定音调; v... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of a person's voice; n. (linguistics) a pitch or change in pitch of the voice that serves to di...
via vaɪə POS: prep	prep. 经由, 经过, 通过; [医] 病毒灭活剂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. A road way.; prep. By the way of; as, to send a letter via Queenstown to; London.
therapy 'θerəpi POS: n	n. 治疗; [医] 疗法, 治疗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (medicine) the act of caring for someone (as by medication or remedial training etc.)
fifth fɪfθ POS: num	num. 第五, 五分之一 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a quantity of liquor equal to one fifth of a United States gallon; n. position five in a countable series o...
pan pæn POS: n	n. 平锅, 浅盘, 盆地, 硬土层, 拍摄全景; v. 上下左右移动, 摇镜头, 淘洗, 淘金 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. cooking utensil consisting of a wide metal vessel; n. (Greek mythology) god of fields and woods and shepher...

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tunnel 'tʌnl POS: n	n. 隧道, 地下道; vi. 挖隧道; vt. 掘隧道于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a passageway through or under something, usually underground (especially one for trains or cars); v. force...
barrel 'bærəl POS: n	n. 桶; vt. 装入桶内 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tube through which a bullet travels when a gun is fired; n. a cylindrical container that holds liquids; n. ...
tide taɪd POS: n	n. 潮, 潮汐, 趋势, 潮流, 涨潮, 高潮; vt. 使随潮漂流; vi. 顺潮行驶 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the periodic rise and fall of the sea level under the gravitational pull of the moon; n. something that may...
piano pi'ɑ:nəu POS: n	n. 钢琴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a keyboard instrument that is played by depressing keys that cause hammers to strike tuned strings and pro...
fluid 'flu:ɪd POS: n	n. 液体, 分泌液, 流体; a. 流动的, 可改变的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a substance that is fluid at room temperature and pressure; n. continuous amorphous matter that tends to fl...
jazz dʒæz POS: n	n. 爵士乐, 喧闹; a. 爵士乐的, 喧闹的; vi. 演奏爵士乐, 跳爵士舞, 游荡; vt. 奏爵士乐, 使活泼 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a genre of popular music that originated in New Orleans around 1900 and developed through increasingly com...
ray rei POS: n	n. 光线, 射线, 闪烁, 光辉; vi. 射出光线, 浮现, 放射光线; vt. 放射, 显出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a branch of an umbel or an umbelliform inflorescence; n. (mathematics) a straight line extending from a poi...
chop tʃɒp POS: n	n. 肋条肉, 排骨, 砍, 戳记, 商标; vt. 剁碎, 砍, 切击, 割断; vi. 砍, 突然转向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the irregular motion of waves (usually caused by wind blowing in a direction opposite to the tide); n. a sm...
drum drʌm POS: n	n. 鼓, 鼓声; vi. 击鼓, 作鼓声; vt. 打鼓奏出; [计] 磁鼓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a musical percussion instrument; usually consists of a hollow cylinder with a membrane stretched across ea...
whip hwɪp POS: n	n. 鞭子, 抽打, 车夫, 搅拌器; vt. 鞭打, 搅拌, 煽动, 召集, 仓促制成; vi. 拍击, 急走, 抽打 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an instrument with a handle and a flexible lash that is used for whipping; n. a legislator appointed by the...
mushroom 'mʌʃrʊm POS: n	n. 蘑菇形物, 蘑菇, 暴发户; vi. 迅速生长, 迅速增加, 采蘑菇; a. 蘑菇形的, 迅速生长的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. common name for an edible agaric (contrasting with the inedible toadstool); n. mushrooms and related fleshy...
usage 'ju:sɪdʒ POS: n	n. 用法, 使用, 习惯, 惯用法, 习惯法; [经] 使用情况, 使用用途, 惯例 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the customary manner in which a language (or a form of a language) is spoken or written
cargo 'kɑ:gəu POS: n	n. 货物; [经] 货柜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. goods carried by a large vehicle
spit spɪt POS: n	n. 唾液, 唾吐, 小雨, 炙叉, 一铲的深度; vt. 唾吐, 吐出, 降小雨, 用炙叉穿过; vi. 吐唾液, 吐痰, 唾弃, 飘霏霏细雨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a narrow strip of land that juts out into the sea; n. a skewer for holding meat over a fire; n. the act of s...
knot nɒt POS: n	n. 结, 群, 难题; v. 打结, (使)纠缠 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tight cluster of people or things; n. any of various fastenings formed by looping and tying a rope (or co...
spur spɜː POS: n	n. 马刺, 刺激物, 鼓舞; vt. 刺激, 激励, 用马刺策(马)前进; vi. 用马刺驱马, 疾驰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any sharply pointed projection; n. tubular extension at the base of the corolla in some flowers; n. a sharp...
curl kɜ:l POS: n	n. 拳曲, 鬚发; vt. 弄卷; vi. 拳曲, 弯曲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. American chemist who with Richard Smalley and Harold Kroto discovered fullerenes and opened a new branch o...
rocky 'rɒki POS: a	a. 岩石的, 多石的, 像岩石的, 无情的, 摇动的, 摇晃的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. abounding in rocks or stones; s. liable to rock; s. full of hardship or trials
berry 'beri POS: n	n. 浆果; vi. 采集浆果 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of numerous small and pulpy edible fruits; used as desserts or in making jams and jellies and preserve...
hardship 'hɑ:dʃɪp POS: n	n. 艰难, 辛苦, 苦难; [法] 受苦, 吃苦, 苦难 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that causes or entails suffering
endurance ɪn'dʒʊərəns POS: n	n. 忍耐, 忍耐力, 耐性; [机] 持九性 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the power to withstand hardship or stress

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
coil kɔɪl POS: n	n. 线圈, 盘绕, 骚动, 卷; vt. 盘绕, 卷 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure consisting of something wound in a continuous series of loops; n. a round shape formed by a ser...
jeep dʒi:p POS: n	n. 吉普车; vi. 乘吉普车; vt. 用吉普车运 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a car suitable for traveling over rough terrain
pronunciation prəʊ.nʌnsi'eɪʃən POS: n	n. 发音, 读法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the manner in which someone utters a word; n. the way a word or a language is customarily spoken
thermometer θə'mɒmɪtə POS: n	n. 温度计, 体温计; [化] 温度计 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. measuring instrument for measuring temperature
tame teɪm POS: a	a. 驯服的, 柔顺的, 被开垦的, 顺从的, 乏味的, 平淡的; vt. 驯养, 驯服, 制服, 失去锋芒; vi. 变得驯服 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. correct by punishment or discipline; s. flat and uninspiring; a. very restrained or quiet; a. brought from wi...